

Examples of ‘Abdul ‘Azīz al Rayyis' attacks on al ‘Allāmah al Fawzān in his treatise: Jawābī li ba’d al Fudhulā (My Response to Some Virtuous People)

[By the student of Shaykh Sālih al Fawzān, Shaykh Mubārak al ‘Assāf (may Allah preserve them)]

As for what follows:

On Tuesday, 19/3/1432 AH, a fatwa was issued by our noble Shaykh, al ‘Allāmah Sālih al Fawzān—may Allah preserve him—in regard to the book al Ilmām Sharh Nawāqidh al Islām by its author ‘Abdul ‘Azīz bin Rayyis al Rayyis.

And this is the text of the fatwa:

The questioner said:

“I found a book being sold in bookstores called al Ilmām bi Sharh Nawāqidh al Islām. Its author states that the excuse of ignorance applies generally to every act of disbelief, and that a polytheist who worships other than Allah, if he is one who ascribes himself to Islām and pronounces the two testimonies...”

al ‘Allāmah al Fawzān (interrupting) replied:

“This is Irjā’! We have read this. We realized that it is a book of Irjā’!

And it contradicts the nullifiers that Shaykh al Islām mentioned. He claims to be explaining them, but in reality he is refuting the Shaykh. He is refuting the Shaykh. This book should be confiscated, and people should not be deceived by it.”

End quote.

After this fatwa was issued, al Rayyis published a book responding to our Shaykh entitled:

My Response to Some Virtuous People Regarding His Description of Me and My Book al Ilmām as Irjā’.

al Rayyis filled it with misguidance, deception, lies, falsification, and attacks and accusations against Shaykh al Fawzān that no one who knows the rank of the scholars of the Sunnah would dare to make!

In this treatise, I will mention some of the attacks of this misguided pretender to knowledge against our Shaykh al ‘Allāmah Sālih al Fawzān—especially since al Rayyis has recently been spreading his book with the help of his followers, after they obtained some praise from the Shaykh due to al Rayyis misleading the mashāyikh and scholars by claiming that he had retracted his Irjā’ and misguidance, while behind their backs he continues to spread what they warned against and circulates his refutations of our Shaykh. And Allah is the One whose help is sought.

1) ‘Abdul ‘Azīz al Rayyis said in his article My Response to Some Virtuous People:

“One of the people of knowledge and virtue mentioned on Tuesday (19/3/1432 AH) that there is Irjā’ in my book al Ilmām fī Sharh Nawāqidh al Islām, because it establishes the excuse of ignorance for Muslims who fall into major shirk without negligence.

He was asked: ‘I found a book sold in bookstores called al Ilmām bi Sharh Nawāqidh al Islām . Its author states that the excuse of ignorance applies generally to every act of disbelief, and that a polytheist who worships other than Allah, if he is one who ascribes himself to Islam and pronounces the testimony of faith...’

So he replied:

‘This is Irjā’. We have read it and realized it is a book of Irjā.’ It contradicts the nullifiers mentioned by Shaykh al Islām. He claims to explain them, but he is refuting the Shaykh. This book should be confiscated and people should not be deceived by it.’

Therefore I wished to write a response to what he mentioned—may Allah guide him to His guidance...” End quote.

I say:

This clearly shows that al Rayyis intended Shaykh al ‘Allāmah al Fawzān in this response, since the words he is responding to are precisely the words of our Shaykh al Fawzān.

2) ‘Abdul ‘Azīz al Rayyis claimed that al Fawzān’s criticism of him was general criticism and he claimed that general criticism of someone who has been deemed trustworthy is not accepted.

Then he contradicted himself and called it a detailed criticism! Yet according to him, it was detailed by something that is not even a valid criticism.

He said in response to al ‘Allāmah al Fawzān:

“All of this concerns general criticism. So what about criticism that has been explained by something that is not a criticism at all, since it relates to a disputed issue among Ahlul Sunnah? Otherwise, if this door were opened, the people of the Sunnah would transgress against one another...”

I say:

This contains an accusation of ignorance against Shaykh al ‘Allāmah Sālih al Fawzān, since al Rayyis is claiming that he issued a detailed criticism based upon something that is not actually criticism.

That is: al Fawzān supposedly does not know what warrants criticism and criticized someone for something that is not even grounds for criticism! How grave is the statement coming from the mouth of this deceptive pretender to knowledge! It also contains an accusation that al Fawzān is guilty of oppression and transgression, since al Rayyis says:

“If this door were opened, the people of the Sunnah would transgress against one another.”

So does al Fawzān's response, description, and ruling regarding you open the door of transgression among the Salafīs!? So O people of reason and insight, look at how this al Rayyis attacks the leading Imām of Ahlul Sunnah in his time with such ugly speech, accusing him of ignorance, transgression, and injustice.

They say about the Ikhwān that they attack the scholars, yet they attack the scholars just like them—rather even more severely—because they outwardly claim adherence to Salafiyyah and the Sunnah.

As Abū Hātim al Rāzī said:

“The sign of the people of innovation is attacking the people of narrations.”

(‘Aqīdat al Salaf by al Sābūnī, pg. 118)

3) al Rayyis said while responding to Shaykh al ‘Allāmah Sālih al Fawzān:

“After all this, can any fair-minded person persist in describing one who believes this as a Murji’? Indeed, I advise every transgressor, or one who transgressed

and then realized the truth, to make up for lost time by returning from his transgression. For the one against whom transgression is committed is aided, even if after some time, and is greatly rewarded if he meets transgression with patience and seeking reward.

He the Most High said:

'Then if one has been wronged, Allah will surely aid him.'

I say:

In reality, O al Rayyis, transgression, ignorance, and injustice are more fitting descriptions for you. You have wronged and transgressed against Shaykh al Fawzān. Allah takes vengeance for His allies, so do not feel secure from Allah's punishment. Hasten to repentance and return, humility, and submission. Leave off deception, scheming, attacks, transgression, injustice, and aggression, for you have engaged in much of that.

4) 'Abdul 'Azīz al Rayyis said regarding Shaykh Sālih al Fawzān:

"I came across some remarks from one of the people of virtue and knowledge in which he described me as a pretender to knowledge—may Allah pardon him and protect me from the evil of my soul and the evil consequences of my deeds—because I stated that the conditions of La ilaha illa Allah are more than seven. And how often he has described with this — may Allah pardon him — even scholars whose status as Imāms has become widely known among Ahlul Sunnah."

I say: These are among al Rayyis's clear attacks, his false accusations, his failed audacity, and his manifest deviations! For does Imām al Fawzān describe someone as a pretender to knowledge without justification!?

Has al Fawzān ever described the scholars of the Sunnah as pretenders to knowledge!?

Yet al Rayyis brazenly boasts, saying:

"How often he has used this description—may Allah pardon him—even for scholars whose status as leading Imāms has become widely recognized among Ahlul Sunnah." May Allah declare our Shaykh, al 'Allāmah al Fawzān, far above the attacks of this fabricator, liar, and aggressor.

As it has been said:

How many a learned and virtuous scholar has been insulted

By one who is not worth a stitch in his sandal.

As for his describing you as a pretender to knowledge, then this is true beyond doubt. You brought it upon yourself. You spoke outside your field of expertise, established false principles, and authored destructive foundations. Thus our Shaykh was justified in describing you as you deserve. What is required of you is to restrain your tongue and your pen from attacking our Imām, and to attend his lessons so that you may learn the correct creed and be saved from the disgrace of sin and following.

5) ‘Abdul ‘Azīz bin Rayyis al Rayyis attacked the Shaykh when he said at the conclusion of his treatise:

“Therefore, it is not correct that he be left to continue declaring people innovators and describing them with Irjā’ over an issue concerning which the Imāms of the Sunnah differed, as has preceded in the quotations from some of them.”

I say: This is an extremely ugly statement that contains a serious attack upon al ‘Allāmah al Fawzān, for al Rayyis is accusing him of declaring people innovators over issues of disagreement!

And it is in reality agreed-upon matters of creed.

This misguided pretender to knowledge speaks about al ‘Allāmah al Fawzān as though he were speaking about a reckless man in issuing rulings, or an ignorant man in matters of criticism and praise and the rulings concerning names and rulings. But it is his desires that have blinded him, causing him to attack without restraint the Shaykh of his age and the great scholar of his era!

O al Rayyis, afflicted in yourself and a cause of trial for others! Be humbled—you will never exceed your station.

For Shaykh al Fawzān is known for knowledge and virtue, among the people of knowledge and virtue. So he is not among the ignorant reckless individuals who declare people innovators based upon whims and suspicions. Rather, he is a scholar who carefully investigates his rulings and exercises deliberation before issuing criticism.

So restrain yourself from your deviation, distance yourself from your desires, and save yourself from your falsehood.

This is only a drop from the ocean of this pretender to knowledge's attacks against the Shaykh, the scholar (Sālih al Fawzān). Therefore, O you who circulate this response against our Shaykh al 'Allāmah al Fawzān—with all the poor manners, lack of knowledge, abundance of deception, and severity of attack that it contains—bear the burden of your deeds and the burden of those who are misled because of you.

Know that your claim of agreeing with al Fawzān and returning to his position has been exposed by your lies, your deception, and your scheming. You are partners in the sin and partners in attacking al 'Allāmah al Fawzān. Even if you outwardly claim to love him and rally around him, by the Lord of the Ka'bah, you are liars.

Your actions belie your words. Do not be deceived, for the consequences will return upon you, even if the duration of your falsehood is prolonged.

Imam Ishāq bin Rāhawayh said:

"Do not be alarmed by falsehood, for falsehood has a turn, then it vanishes" (al Jarh wa al Ta'dīl, 1/329).

So al Rayyis and those who spread his response against Shaykh al Fawzān—including those enamored with al Rayyis and everyone who spreads and defends the book al Ilmām, wherever they may be—have much awaiting them because of this propagation. Await the consequences of their transgression and the outcome of their scheming. They plan, and Allah plans, and Allah is the best of planners

Thus we know that these people possess immense deception. They face al Fawzān one way, while behind his back they spread refutations against him! I wrote this so that people may know that they republished al Rayyis's response to Shaykh al Fawzān after al Rayyis received some praise from the Shaykh due to al Rayyis' false claim that he had retracted. This is tremendous scheming, mastered only by one who harbors hidden malice—Allah's refuge is sought.

Their claim of returning to the scholars is nothing but throwing dust into people's eyes. Allah is their Reckoner, and He is sufficient for us against their evil and their plotting. I intended to clarify the truth for the people—a truth that is evident to whoever seeks and desires it. As for one whose desires dominate him, we have no way over him.

May Allah send His prayers and peace upon our Prophet Muhammad, and upon his family and companions.

Written by:

Mubārak bin Khalīfah bin Muhammad al ‘Assāf

Saturday, 17/11/1437 AH

APPENDIX

25/10/2018

11,861

جوابي لبعض الفضلاء عن
وصفه لي ولكتابي (الإمام)
بالإرجاء

د. عبدالعزيز بن ريس الرئيس

الرد على المخالف \ الكتب

جوابي لبعض الفضلاء

قراءة الكتاب



تنزيل الكتاب



Above you can see the treatise of al Rayyis which Shaykh al ‘Assāf is referring to is still on al Rayyis’ website.

al Rayyis still recommends his followers to read this treatise. You can also find al Rayyis and his followers continue to spread his book “al Ilmām” which Shaykh al Fawzān called a book of irjā’ and called for it to be banned.

Below is al Rayyis’ supposed retraction from Irjā’, it is a general declaration of him being free from the bid’ah of the Khawārij and the Bid’ah of the Murji’ah.

وبعد إليك ما كتبت من مختصر الإيمان المشار إليه:

بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

الحمد لله رب العالمين والصلاة والسلام على نبينا
محمد وعلى آله وصحبه أجمعين:

أعتقد أنا: عبد العزيز بن ريس الرئيس أن الإيمان قول
وعمل واعتقاد ، يزيد بالطاعة وينقص بالمعصية كما
عليه أهل السنة والجماعة . وأتبرأ من طريقة الخوارج
الذين يكفرون بالكبيرة التي دون الشرك، كما أتبرأ من
طريقة المرجئة الذين يخرجون العمل عن حقيقة
الإيمان ويقولون: لا يضر مع الإيمان معصية . وكل ما
قلته أو كتبت أو نسب إلي مما يخالف هذا فأنا راجع
عنه - إن وجد - وملتزم بما عليه السلف الصالح وأهل
السنة والجماعة في حقيقة الإيمان.

وأسأل الله الثبات على ذلك إلى الممات . وصلى الله
وسلم على نبينا محمد وعلى آله وصحبه

عبد العزيز بن ريس الرئيس

1434 / 4 / 29 هـ

Nowhere does it mention explicitly retracting from what he was directly criticized for by numerous senior scholars such as Shaykh Sālih al Fawzān, Shaykh ‘Abdul ‘Azīz Āl al-Shaykh, Shaykh ‘Abdul ‘Azīz al Rājihī, and Shaykh ‘Abdullah al Ghunaymān.

The main reason as we all know that al Rayyis was warned against and described with severe *irjā’* was his arguing on behalf of the Mushrikīn and labeling them as Muslims, and lying upon many scholars trying to say they supported the same *bid’ah* he does.

We as well as the blind followers of al Rayyis can acknowledge this is the reason why so many Mashayikh spoke against him. So does al Rayyis still spread this belief or not? One of the things he is most famous for until this day is excusing the Mushrikīn even those who live among the Muslims and have access to scholars and knowledge. By excusing the Mushrikīn he means they are in reality Muslims.

What does this tell us about his supposed repentance/retraction!? Add to this he and his followers continue to spread his books which the Mashayikh warned against as well as the treatise in which he attacked Shaykh al Fawzān and tried to defend his *irjā’*!

Add to this, a number of former students of al Rayyis have stated that in private gatherings, al Rayyis admitted to them that he did not retract from anything, he only claimed to in front of Shaykh al Fawzān to gain his praise! And still he could not control his tongue from attacking the Shaykh!!



حقيقة تراجع الرئيس للشيخ عبد الله بن صالح الفوزان حفظه الله

حقيقة تراجع الرئيس للشيخ عبد الله بن صالح الفوزان حفظه الله

الحمد لله رب العالمين والصلاة والسلام على رسول الله وبعد:
فإن بعض الناس قد قاموا في يوم الجمعة الموافق 12/شعبان/1434هـ بإحضار الشيخ عبدالعزيز بن ريس الرئيس إلى حفر الباطن، وجموعه من الإخوة والشباب وألقى عليهم كلمة، وكان من ذلك أنه أتى بكلام على شيخنا العلامة صالح بن فوزان الفوزان حفظه الله تعالى لا يليق، وبأن من ذلك أن ما كتبه من تراجع فيما سبق عن المؤاخذات في الإرجاء إنما هو في الحقيقة غير صحيح، وأنه تدليس وتلبيس، وكأن المراد فيما كتب الحصول على شيء من الكتابة من الشيخ صالح الفوزان ليدراً بها من تكلم عليه وحذر من أخطائه وطريقته، مثل الشيخ عبدالسلام البرجس رحمه الله، كما أخبرني بذلك الشيخ عبدالكريم بن محمد المنيف رحمه الله والشيخ محمد بن هادي المدخلي حفظه الله، ومثل الشيخ عبيد الجابري في رد مفصل عليه.

فأقول موضحاً ما تقدم :

أولاً : إن الرئيس لما اجتمع بأولئك الشباب والإخوة، وذكروا تراجعهم عما لاحظ عليه الشيخ صالح الفوزان وانتقده عليه من أمور الإرجاء، أجابهم مبيناً أنه لم يكن قد أخطأ، وأنه لم يتراجع، وأن ما كتبه إنما هو مجاملة للفوزان وعدم إحراج له، لأنه تبين للشيخ للفوزان - فيما يزعم الرئيس - أنه قد أخطأ في حقه، فكتب الرئيس ما كتب من تراجع استحياءً من الشيخ وحتى لا يخرجه أمام الناس - كذا قال - كما حدثني به مجموعة من الإخوة ممن حضر ومن سمع من حضر منهم. وهذا الكلام المتجرد من الأدب من جميع النواحي مع الشيخ صالح الفوزان يدل على حقيقة الرئيس وكتابته، والتي أوهم فيها التراجع، وهو في الحقيقة لم يتراجع، وذلك عندما قال فيما كتبه : وكل ما قلت أو كتبت أو نسب إلي مما يخالف هذا فأنا راجع عنه إن وجد!! فإن قوله (إن وجد) : يشير به أن ما انتقد عليه غير موجود في الحقيقة.

Dr. Abdullah Al-Dhufayri said:

"Firstly, when Al-Rayyis met with those young men and brothers, they mentioned to him his retraction concerning the issues of Irja for which Shaykh Salih Al-Fawzan had criticized and refuted him.

☞ (!) Al-Rayyis responded by claiming that he had not been mistaken, that he had not retracted, and that what he wrote was merely out of courtesy toward Shaykh Al-Fawzan so as not to embarrass him (i.e., embarrass Al-Fawzan by refuting his claim)!

☞ (!) This was because, according to Al-Rayyis' claim, it had become clear to Shaykh Al-Fawzan that he (i.e., Al-Fawzan) had wronged him. Therefore, Al-Rayyis wrote what appeared to be a 'retraction' out of shyness before the Shaykh and so as not to embarrass him in front of the people. This is what he (i.e., Al-Rayyis) claimed.

This was related to me by a group of brothers, some of whom were present at the gathering, while others heard it directly from those who attended.

👉 (!) This statement, which is completely devoid of proper manners toward Shaykh Salih Al-Fawzan in every respect, demonstrates the true reality of Al-Rayyis and what he wrote as a "retraction." In it, he gave the impression that he had retracted, when in reality he had not.

This is evident from what he wrote:

"Everything that I have said, written, or that has been attributed to me which contradicts this, I retract from it, if it exists."

By adding the phrase, "if it exists," he was implying that the statements for which he had been criticized and refuted for did not actually exist. In other words, he was not acknowledging any mistake or retracting from his previous statements. Rather, he was asserting that the criticism and refutation itself was unfounded and, in reality, (the alleged Irja) never existed." End quote.

Note: we have received messages from brothers in Saudi who stated similar things about the speech of al Rayyis in private gatherings about this topic.

Credit: Authentic Answers Telegram Channel.

SEVERAL STATEMENTS OF SHAYKH SĀLIH AL FAWZĀN ABOUT THE CONTEMPORARY MURJI'AH

1) Shaykh Sālih al Fawzān said in his Commentary on Fath al Majīd (2/22) warning against the Murji'ah who excuse the Mushrikīn today claiming they are ignorant (and therefore Muslims!):

His statement [Shaykh Muhammad bin ‘Abdul Wahhāb] may Allah have mercy on him: “And that he is not excused due to ignorance.”

That he is not excused on the due to ignorance. “For if you were to die while it was upon you, you would never attain success.” This is despite the fact that he wore it out of ignorance—he put it on while he was ignorant.

The Murji'ah now say that they are excused due to ignorance. But how can ignorance be claimed when the Qurān is being recited to them, and it contains the prohibition of shirk, and the threat of punishment for it? And eternity in the Fire? How is there ignorance? Until when!?... End quote.

2) The Murji'ah in our time are trying to destroy the dawah of Shaykh Muḥammad Ibn 'Abd al-Wahhāb and want to affirm Islam for the ignorant mushrik who claims to be Muslim! By Shaykh Ṣāliḥ al-Fawzān

The Questioner: Shaykh, is one who tracks the people of misguidance and brings their books to the scholars so they can respond to them considered a mujāhid in the way of Allah?

The Shaykh replied: Yes, he is considered as someone striving in enjoining good and forbidding evil and in spreading beneficial knowledge.

The questioner said: Allāhu Akbar, Shaykh, may Allah bless you. Another question: there is a book available on the internet, Shaykh, The website is called Sahāb al-Salafiyyah (known as Sahab.net), and the book is titled Al-'Udhru bil-Jahl 'inda A'immat al-Da'wah. The author is Rashīd ibn Aḥmad 'Uwaish al-Maghribī, Shaykh, may Allah reward you with goodness.

The Shaykh said: This is the group of Irjā'. This is the group of Irjā'; we have been afflicted by them from inside and outside, but we ask Allah to protect us from their evil.

The questioner said: May Allah reward you. Shaykh, if you like, may I read a passage to you?

The Shaykh replied: It is well-known, well-known, Shaykh. This is their madhhab. Now it has emerged among us and is spread by people from outside. They say Irjā', and that you are not to declare anyone a disbeliever. If you say that a mushrik is a disbeliever, or that such-and-such is a disbeliever... these are ignorant; they do not declare anyone a disbeliever. This is their intent.

Their aim is to bury this call – the call of Shaykh Muḥammad ibn 'Abd al-Wahhāb – to make everyone merely a “Muslim,” such that whoever utters the word Islām is considered a Muslim, no matter what they do.

The questioner said: A'ūdhu billāh, Shaykh, may Allah bless you. If you permit, may we read this text to you?

The Shaykh replied: No need, I know them; I am familiar with their words and know them well.

The questioner said: May Allah grant you Paradise.

The Shaykh concluded: We have been tested with them; may Allah guide them and protect us from their evil. End quote.

3) Shaykh al-Fawzān warning against a hidden group of Murji'ah claiming to be upon Salafiyyah conspiring to destroy the 'aqīdah of the salaf. he was asked:

Q: may Allah reward you with good. There also appeared a book titled: “Ḍabṭ al-Dawābiṭ fī al-Īmān wa-Nawāqidiḥ” (by Aḥmad az-Zahrānī). In it, its author established that outward actions ...

A: Yes, this one as well, its author has made manifest the madhhab of Irjā'; he defends the doctrine of Irjā' and claims that it is the truth. And now it is with al-Lajnah, and a clarification and warning will be issued regarding it, inshā' Allāh, explaining what it contains of confusion, disorder, and ignorance, there is no power nor might except with Allah.

It was preceded by books similar to it, and this one apparently belongs to an institution that is operating! Apparently it is an institution working to corrupt the 'aqīdah of the salaf in this land! A secret institution that is operating!

So the obligation is, even if they name so-and-so or so-and-so, these names are aliases. Apparently behind it are people working in secrecy!!!

Q: There are groups affiliating themselves with Salafiyyah who are now calling to the doctrine of Irjā'.

A: As we mentioned, yes, these people who affiliate themselves with Salafiyyah are deceptive and treacherous!

They are not from the salaf! And they want to corrupt the 'aqīdah of this land! Because there is hardly anything left in the Islamic world like this land, which holds firmly to the 'aqīdah and methodology of the salaf. And they want, yes, they want, to blur this 'aqīdah here so that it becomes equal to everything else, but they will not reach their objective, by the power of Allah.

End Quote.

[Explanation of Nūniyyah of Ibn al-Qayyim- Tape 28]

4) Shaykh al-Fawzān (may Allah preserve him) said:

This Insidious doctrine of Irjā' — the most vile form of Irjā' — is also the madhhab that says: if a servant affirms the existence of Allāh and His rubūbiyyah, then that is sufficient for him to be a believer.

Even if he commits whatever he commits of sins, disbelief, and atheism — so long as he does not deny the existence of Allāh, nor deny His divinity, nor the

message of the Prophet ﷺ — then he is a believer, complete in īmān. No matter how ugly his actions are, they do not harm him. They are merely sins, while he remains a believer, complete in īmān.

They were called Murji'ah because they postponed actions — meaning they delayed them from the definition of īmān. This is clear disbelief. Meaning: whoever insults Allāh and His Messenger, prostrates to an idol, commits whatever forms of disbelief, tramples upon copies of the Muṣḥaf, and does whatever he does — as long as he believes in Allāh and His Messenger and does not deny — then he is a believer, and these actions are only sins. This is a vile madhhab.

With them, kufr is only denial (takdhīb), and īmān is only affirmation (taṣdīq). This has now appeared among some who ascribe themselves to Sunnah, though pretenders to knowledge, led by some senior half-learned figures. They now openly state this doctrine and say: disbelief is only takdhīb. As for actions and statements, they do not harm — so long as he prays.

Even statements and actions — even if he insults Allāh and His Messenger — they say it is merely bad manners, because he believes in Allāh and His Messenger in his heart and is not a denier.

This is a clear madhhab of disbelief against Islām — we seek refuge in Allāh. It is the madhhab of the extreme Murji'ah from the Jahmiyyah. But perhaps these half-learned ones did not realize this matter nor recognize the extent of its vileness due to their ignorance. They did not truly learn; rather, their knowledge is from papers.

They took their knowledge from pages and reading in books. They did not sit in the gatherings of scholars to learn the manhaj of Ahl al-Sunnah wal-Jamā'ah and understand it. Instead, they devoted themselves to papers, annotating, commenting, and writing, thinking themselves to be scholars. This is a calamity upon Islām. The appearance of such people over Islām is without a doubt dangerous. This is a wicked madhhab. End Quote.

5) Shaykh al-Fawzān was asked:

Q: What is the ruling on the common people of the Rāfiḍah? Is their ruling the same as their scholars?

A: O brothers, leave this speech. The Rāfiḍah their ruling is one, do not philosophise with us. Their ruling is one. All of them hear the Qur'ān, all of them

read; rather most of them memorise the Qur'ān.

The proof has reached them, the proof has been established against them. Leave us from these philosophies and this irjā' which has spread now among some youth and those who claim knowledge. Leave this.

Whoever the Qur'ān reaches, the proof has been established against him: {And this Qur'ān was revealed to me that I may warn you thereby and whomever it reaches} [al-An'ām: 19], until the Day of Resurrection. End quote.

6) Shaykh Ṣāliḥ al-Fawzān was asked:

Q: Regarding the ḥadīth of the man who entered the Fire because of a fly, is it taken from this narration that ignorance is not an excuse in matters of shirk in worship, since this man was ignorant yet was not excused and entered the Fire?

A: It appears that irjā' has become firmly rooted in some of those present! The ḥadīth contains none of these issues. The ḥadīth is clear, the man sacrificed to other than Allah. He preferred his own safety over his 'aqīdah, and so he became one of the people of the Fire. We do not engage in these absurdities and these cold questions. End quote.

7) Shaykh al-Fawzān was asked:

Q: Is this statement correct: “Everyone who falls into one of the nullifiers of Islam, we do not judge the specific individual; so we do not say: ‘You are a kāfir,’ rather we judge his action or statement as kufr”?

A: This is the statement of the Murji'ah. You are repeating to us the speech of the Murji'ah; this is the speech of the Murji'ah. Rather, the ruling is applied to him according to what he did or said. We have nothing except the outward. We do not search beyond the outward. Whoever commits kufr, we declare him a kāfir. Whoever commits shirk, we consider him a mushrik. We have nothing except the outward. As for the hearts, none knows what is in them except Allāh, exalted and Most High.

If it happens that a person makes du'ā' to other than Allāh and worships graves and shrines, then dies—do you wash him? Do you pray over him while he is a mushrik? Do you bury him in the graveyards of the Muslims while he is a mushrik? You have nothing except the outward. You judge by what is outwardly apparent—unless he was ignorant, not knowing, and one like him is excused by ignorance; then you excuse him due to ignorance (i.e. treated as ahl al-fatrah). But to say: “We consider this kufr, but its doer is not a kāfir”—how can he

commit kufr and not be a kāfir? How can he utter a word of kufr and not be a kāfir?.

Q: Regarding the specific individual, is it required that the conditions of takfīr be fulfilled and its impediments removed?

A: The specific individual and the non-specific—what concerns us is only the outward, O brothers. We have nothing except the outward. We judge people according to what appears from them. As for the inner realities and the hearts, none knows them except Allāh, exalted and Most High. End quote.

8) Shaykh al Fawzān was asked:

Q: Has the issue of ‘udhr bil-jahl been differed over by the scholars and the Salaf, or is it...?

A: This was brought by the contemporary Murji’ah. “‘udhr bil-jahl”, “‘udhr bil-jahl” in everything there is ‘udhr bil-jahl, meaning?

There is no Qur’ān, no Sunnah, nothing at all, everything is ignorance! Until when? Until when is there ignorance?. End quote.

9) Shaykh al Fawzān was asked:

Q: Some people have emerged among us who refrain from making takfīr of the one who performs sujūd to other than Allāh and the one who sacrifices to other than Allāh, with the argument that it is necessary to ask the person about the reason for doing this..

A: We judge by the outward appearance. Whoever performs sujūd to other than Allāh, we judge him with kufr based on his outward appearance.

As for what is in the hearts, none knows it except Allāh. We have not been tasked to examine the hearts; we judge by the outward appearance.

Whoever does shirk, we judge him as a mushrik, and whoever does kufr, we judge that he is a kāfir. This is a group of the Murji’ah that has appeared now, they are the ones who say these statements. End quote.

10) Shaykh al-Fawzān said regarding the statement:

“And the servant does not exit from īmān except by denying that which caused him to enter into it.”

This statement contains an objection, because restricting kufr to denial (juḥūd) is the madhhab of the Murji'ah. The nullifiers of Islam are many: among them is juḥūd, among them is associating partners with Allah, among them is mocking the religion or anything from it—even without denial—and they are many nullifiers mentioned by the scholars and jurists in the chapters of apostasy. Among them also is making the unlawful, lawful and making the lawful, unlawful.

Shaykh al-Islām Muḥammad ibn ‘Abd al-Wahhāb mentioned ten of them, and they are the most important, otherwise the nullifiers are many. So restricting the nullifiers of Islam to denial alone is an error.

Some of the muta‘ālimūn (pseudo-scholars) today try to promote this madhhab so that people become lenient in the religion. As long as he has not denied, then according to them he is a Muslim: even if he prostrates to an idol and says, “I did not deny, and I affirm tawḥīd—it is only a sin from the sins.” Or if he sacrifices to other than Allah, or reviles Allah, or reviles the Messenger, or reviles the religion—they say: this is a Muslim because he did not deny.

This is a great error, and it completely destroys the religion, leaving no religion remaining. So it is obligatory to beware of this great danger.

[At-Ta‘līqāt al-Mukhtaṣarah ‘alā Matn al-‘Aqīdah aṭ-Ṭaḥāwīyyah p.144]

11) Shaykh Ṣāliḥ al-Fawzān said:

And there are people now who say: a person does not disbelieve even if he speaks disbelief until he believes it in his heart. So if he says words of disbelief without compulsion, and does actions of disbelief, and reviles Allah and His Messenger, and does whatever he does, then he is not declared a disbeliever according to these people until what is in his heart is known.

And this is the madhhab of the extremists of the Murji'ah. We ask Allah for well-being and safety.

[Sharḥ Masā’il al-Jāhiliyyah by Muḥammad ibn ‘Abd al-Wahhāb by Shaykh Ṣāliḥ al-Fawzān p.276]

12) Only the Murji'ah Excuse Everyone Without Distinction Between Clear and Unclear Matters.

 STATEMENT:

Shaykh, Mufti, and Imam Salih al-Fawzan said:

All praise is for Allah. To proceed:

The issue of excusing ignorance is a matter that contains detail, contrary to the Murji'ah who rely upon it without making distinctions.

The ignorant person is of two states:

1. The state of one who is distant and isolated, to whom the da'wah has not reached.

- This one is excused (i.e., as ahlul fatrah) due to his ignorance until the da'wah reaches him in a manner he can understand if he seeks to understand.

2. The state of one to whom the da'wah has reached.

- This one is not excused due to ignorance, because he is negligent in not learning and removing his ignorance.

This applies in the clear matters of Aqeedah.

As for the subtle subsidiary matters of ijtiḥād, the ignorant person is excused until it is clarified to him.

 SOURCE: Fatāwā Shaykh 'Abd al-'Azīz ibn Bāz fī al-'Udhri bil-Jahl, Page 7.

13) Shaykh Salih Al-Fawzan on the Extremist Murji'ah Who Suspend Outward Rulings Based on Assumed Inward Preventers (Like Ignorance) and Therefore Affirm Outward Islam for Those Who Commit Clear Shirk and Kufr

 STATEMENT:

Shaykh Salih al-Fawzan said:

Third: "Whoever does not Takfir the Mushrikīn, or doubts their kufr, or corrects their way, is a Kāfir..."

Or he claims that they are merely ignorant and foolish people who fell into this matter out of ignorance, in doing so he defends them (i.e., by affirming their Islam).

 (!) Then such a person (i.e., the one who excuses them as Muslims) is upon a kufr worse and more severe than they are (i.e., the mushrikin)! This is because he has approved of kufr, approved of shirk, or shown doubt regarding it (i.e., by withholding the outward ruling and affirming for them Islam).

 SOURCE: Explanation of Nawāqid al-Islām by Shaykh Salih al-Fawzan (p. 20)

14) The Extreme Murjiah claim: "I do not declare takfir upon them because they say: 'La ilaha illa Allah.' They are our brothers, but they made a mistake."

 **STATEMENT:**

Shaykh Salih al-Fawzan (may Allah protect him) said:

“So the one who says: “I do not declare takfir upon these people; I do not declare takfir upon those who worship al-Hasan, al-Husayn, or al-Badawi. I do not declare takfir upon them because they say: ‘La ilaha illa Allah.’ They are our brothers, but they made a mistake.”

We say to him: YOU ARE A MUSHRIK LIKE THEM!

Because you did not declare takfir upon what is worshiped besides Allah. And Allah the Exalted has placed kufr in the taghut before iman in Allah. Allah, the Most High, said:

“Whoever disbelieves in Taghut and believes in Allah, then he has grasped the most trustworthy handhold that will never break.” [al-Baqarah 2:256]

Therefore, it is obligatory to disbelieve in the taghut, and it is obligatory to disbelieve in whatever is worshiped besides Allah, to believe in its falsehood, and to disassociate from it and from its people.

Otherwise, HE IS NOT A MUSLIM.

Because this is a mixture between Islam and kufr, and kufr and Islam can never coexist.”

 **SOURCE: (I'anat al-Mustafid bi-Sharh Kitab al-Tawhid, 1/134)**

15) Shaykh Ṣāliḥ al-Fawzān was asked:

Questioner: Shaykh, I have a question — may Allah protect you. There are some books and articles that have recently become widespread. I would like to ask you, may Allah preserve you — is it beneficial to read them?

In these writings, the Shaykh affirms that kufr, just as it can occur through juhūd (denial) and takdhīb (rejection), can also occur through speech and action. He says that īmān is a statement of the tongue, belief in the heart, and action of the limbs — and that it increases and decreases until nothing remains except the weight of a tiny particle.

However, he also claims that īmān does not vanish through abandonment, and at the same time asserts that the one who abandons all bodily actions entirely remains a Muslim. He further claims that this is another opinion among Ahl as-Sunnah.

And that it is permissible to pray behind a grave-worshipper who is ignorant and ascribes himself to Islam. And when we warn against such statements and their proponents, he labels us Khawārij and Haddādiyyah. So, Shaykh, is it beneficial to read these books and articles?

The Shaykh replied: No, do not read them!!!! I say to you, do not read them!!!

End quote.

16) May Allah grant you goodness, O noble Shaykh.

This questioner says:

They have an imam in a village who does not declare the grave worshippers to be kuffar individually, even though he acknowledges that their action is shirk.

✓ Shaykh Al-Fawzan said:

You have previously been asked about him, and we said: Do not pray behind him! It is not permissible to pray behind him! He does not declare the kuffar and the mushrikin to be kuffar!

End Quote from Lesson on the book Fath al Majīd 1441 AH.

EXPLANATION OF “THE EXCUSE OF IGNORANCE” FROM THE LAJNAH AL DĀ’IMAH

 The Permanent Committee for Islamic Research and Fatwas in Saudi Arabia.


Fatwah no. 4400:

Question Two from Fatwa No. (4400):

? Question:

There are those who claim: everyone who adheres to the message of Muhammad ﷺ, and faces the qiblah in prayer, even if he prostrates to his shaykh, he does not become a kafir and is not to be called a mushrik. He even went so far as to

say that Muhammad ibn Abd al Wahhab erred and was mistaken when he spoke about the mushrikin being eternally in the Fire if they do not repent. He claims that the mushrikin in this ummah will be punished and then admitted into Paradise, and that no one from the ummah of Muhammad will remain eternally in the Fire.

☞ Answer:

Everyone who believes in the message of our Prophet Muhammad ﷺ and in everything that he brought in the Shariah, then afterward prostrates to other than Allah, such as a wali, a grave, or a shaykh of a Sufi path, then he is a kafir, an apostate from Islam, and a mushrik who has associated partners with Allah in worship, even if he utters the two testimonies at the time of his prostration, because his action nullifies his statement.

However, he may be excused due to ignorance, so the punishment is not carried out upon him until he is taught and the proof is established against him. He is to be given a respite of three days as an excuse extended to him so that he may reconsider himself and perhaps repent. If he persists in prostrating to other than Allah after clarification, he is to be executed for his apostasy, due to the statement of the Prophet ﷺ:

“Whoever changes his religion, then kill him.”

Reported by Imam al-Bukhari in his Sahih from Ibn Abbas (may Allah be pleased with them both).

☞ (!) Thus, clarifying the matter and establishing the proof (Iqāmat al-hujjah) is for the purpose of removing any excuse before carrying out the PUNISHMENT upon him, NOT in order for him to be called a kafir only after the clarification.

☞ (!) Rather, he IS CALLED a kafir based on the outward act he committed.

Such as prostrating to other than Allah, vowing as an act of worship to other than Him, or slaughtering an animal, like a sheep, for other than Allah.”

The Book and the Sunnah have indicated that whoever dies upon shirk will not be forgiven and will abide eternally in the Fire, due to the statement of Allah:

“Indeed, Allah does not forgive that shirk be associated with Him, but He forgives what is less than that for whom He wills” (Quran 4:48),

and His statement:

“It is not for the mushrikin to maintain the mosques of Allah while bearing witness against themselves of kufr. For such, their deeds have become worthless, and in the Fire they will abide eternally” (Quran 9:17).

And may Allah send prayers and peace upon our Prophet Muhammad, and upon his family and his companions.

The Permanent Committee for Scholarly Research and Ifta Permanent Committee for Scholarly Research and Ifta Saudi Arabia. 

President:

Abdulaziz ibn Abdullah ibn Baz

Vice President of the Committee:

Abd al Razzaq Afifi

Member:

Abdullah ibn Qaud

 **SOURCE: Kitāb Fatāwā al-Lajnah al-Dā’imah – First Collection, vol. 1, p. 220**

Refutation of ibn Jirjis and those who inherited his beliefs and doubts

 **STATEMENT:**

Imam Abd al-Latif ibn Abd al-Rahman Aal al-Shaykh (1293H) said:

“Such that he did not even decisively declare takfir upon the ignorant person who supplicates to other than Allah from among the grave worshippers and others, if there was no one available to advise him and convey to him the proof whose abandoner becomes a kafir by abandoning it.

He said in some of his letters:

‘If we do not fight the one who worships the dome of al-Kawwaz until after we first call him to make the religion sincerely for Allah alone, then how can we declare takfir upon the one who did not migrate to us, even if he is a believer and a muwahhid?’

And he also said:

“He was asked about the likes of these ignorant people, so he clarified that whoever the proof has been established upon, and who became capable of understanding it, becomes a kafir due to worshipping the graves. His previous statements regarding this issue are already sufficient and clear.

Likewise, the great scholar Ibn al-Qayyim, rahimahullah, decisively affirmed the kufr of those blind followers who imitate their shaykhs in matters of kufr, when they are capable of seeking and knowing the truth, and qualified to understand it, yet they still turn away from it and refuse to accept it.

👉 (!) As for the one who was genuinely incapable and not qualified to know what the Messengers came with, then according to him, such a person is from the category of Ahl al-Fatrah, those to whom the message of the Messengers did not reach.

👉 (!) Yet despite this, both categories are NOT judged to be Muslims, nor are they included within the designation of Islam, even according to those who refrain from declaring takfir upon some of them, as will be mentioned later.

👉 (!) However, shirk still applies to them, and they are still described with it. For what Islam remains when its very foundation and greatest principle, the testimony that none has the right to be worshipped except Allah, has been contradicted?

The fuqaha mentioned that Islam may still remain alongside some sins and acts discussed in the chapter of apostasy, but its remaining alongside the worship of the righteous and supplicating to them is far less conceivable.

However, the Iraqi refuses to call this worship and supplication. Instead, he claims it is merely tawassul and calling out, and even considers it recommended.

Far removed from the truth is such a claim.”

📖 SOURCE: Minhaj al-Tasis wa al-Taqdis fi Kashf Shubuhāt Dawūd ibn Jirjis, p. 99.

👉 STATEMENT:

Shaykh al-‘Allamah Ishaq ibn ‘Abd al-Rahman ibn Hasan Al al-Shaykh (d. 1319 AH)

أهل الفترة الذين لم تبلغهم الرسالة والقرآن وماتوا على الجاهلية لا يسمون مسلمين

بالإجماع ولا يستغفر لهم وإنما اختلف أهل العلم في تعذيبهم في الآخرة

"The people of the Fatrah are those whom the message and the Qur'an did not reach and who died upon ignorance.

They are NOT labeled as Muslims by CONSENSUS.

And no one is to seek forgiveness for them. The scholars ONLY differed on whether they will be punished in the Hereafter."

 **SOURCE: Hukm Takfir al-Muayyan wa al-Farq Bayna Qiyam al-Hujjah wa Fahm al-Hujjah, Page: 9**

CONCLUSION

Authentic Answers channel has translated the latest warning of Shaykh Sālih al Fawzān against al Rayyis entitled:

Refutation of AbdulAziz al-Rayyis & Mahir al-Qahtani the Extremist Murjiah | Shaykh Salih al-Fawzan

<https://youtu.be/sX45PhWSzTc>

This phone call is from 1443 AH, years after al Rayyis' supposed retraction. Shaykh 'Abdullah al Ghunaymān also warned against al Rayyis in the same year.

Thus we have shown the deception of 'Abdul 'Azīz al Rayyis and his supposed retraction as well as his clear evil thoughts regarding Shaykh Sālih al Fawzān.

We ask Allah to guide us and him as well as his followers who go to many extremes to defend al Rayyis.

All this shows the:

1) false retraction of al Rayyis. He never even admitted he was upon irjā' all he did was fight that to this day, and attack the scholars and those who follow them in condemning the extreme Murji'ah today who argue that the Mushrikīn among those who ascribe to Islām are actually misguided Muslims even if they commit clear shirk and nullifiers of Islām.

2) al Rayyis never retracted from what he was criticized for, in fact he still openly calls to the same misguidance today. He labels those who oppose him as takfīrīs, haddādīs, and other names, all due to the opposition to his irjā' and

calling those who worship other than Allah Muslims, monotheists, even if they believe in Wahdatul Wujood and worship idols and perform magic! al Rayyis and his followers continue to this day to spread his misguided beliefs and works which were warned against by the scholars.

3) those in al Rayyis' own circle testify to him saying in private that he never retracted from what he was criticized for by numerous scholars, and that he spoke against Shaykh al Fawzān in those private gatherings as well

4) refutation of the lie of the Murji'ah today who claim Shaykh Sālih al Fawzān (and other scholars) does not deem them to be Murji'ah for their excusing those who abandon Tawheed by labeling them Muwahhidīn.

5) the deceit and lies of the contemporary Murji'ah who hide behind the cloak of Salafiyyah and its scholars, yet Salafiyyah is free from them. This is apparent in their leaders, so what about their followers from the laymen who argue without knowledge to defend their innovation?

For those who wish to read about the contemporary Murji'ah and the areas they became misguided in, and how they try to claim to be upon the Sunnah and hide their misguidance, we suggest the book of Shaykh Sālih bin Muhammad al Suwayyih, which was given introductions by Shaykh Sālih al Fawzān and Shaykh Muhammad bin Hasan bin 'Abdul Rahman Āl al-Shaykh.



Shaykh Ṣāliḥ as-Suwayyih said:

Fourth: stating that the statement of some of those who excuse the grave worshippers is an irjā'ī statement:

Like the one who makes a general statement excusing the grave-worshippers due to ignorance, and not making takfīr them except after they understand it by which the preventing doubt ceases, and he claims that mere knowledge and conveyance, and mere understanding and comprehension of the texts of the Kitāb and the Sunnah, are not sufficient for making takfīr the mushrikīn.

So he claims that it is necessary to discuss and clarify to the mushrikīn and grave worshippers, followed by obstinacy and persistence; and if that is not the case, then the proof has not been established upon him, and he is not judged with shirk individually, rather he remains upon his Islām even if he has engaged in shirk, mixed with it, acted upon it, and called to it!

So according to his claim—he is a Muslim, a muwaḥḥid, not an oppressor!

[al-Furūq bayna 'Aqīdat as-Salaf wa-'Aqīdat al-Murji'ah fī al-Īmān by Shaykh Ṣāliḥ as-Suwayyih pg. 54].

The book was introduced and praised by the Grand Mufti, our imām, Shaykh Ṣāliḥ al-Fawzān, may Allah protect him and all the scholars of the Sunnah.

May Allah protect us all from falling into misguidance of any kind. And we ask Allah to guide 'Abdul 'Azīz al Rayyis and those like him who stubbornly defend and spread this wicked irjā' while attacking the people of the Sunnah who stand up against them. May Allah protect the Muslims from the evil of the Murji'ah and other than them from the people of misguidance.